

Regular Meeting
Monday, November 18, 2019
Medford School Committee
Medford City Hall

Present: Ms. DiBenedetto, Ms. Kreatz, Ms. Mustone, Mr. Ruggiero, Mr. Ruseau, Ms. Van der Kloot, Mayor Burke, Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Assistant Superintendent Peter Cushing.

Roll Call and Salute the Flag - Meeting called to order at 7:06pm.

Approval of the Minutes of October 21, 2019 - Mr. Ruseau - Meeting held at City Hall not Medford High School - motion to approve as amended offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Kreatz, motion passes.

Approval of Bills/Transfer of Funds and Approval of Payrolls - Motion to approve offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Mr. Ruseau. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Report of Committees - Rules Subcommittee meeting held at 6:30pm - Kathy Kreatz discussed the meeting of the Rules subcommittee on the Attendance Policy. In a meeting earlier in October we met with all the administrators. Mr. Ruseau met with MASC and we made some small changes to add the word caregivers. We state the consequences to absences being on the same day as the absence. Going forward we will track updates to policies as listed here in this document. We shared this document with all original attendees to the October 1 meeting and this is the proposed final version, tonight there was one minor update. Motion to approve this document and post to the Medford Public Schools website offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Mayor Burke invited School Committee members-elect Jenny Graham and Melanie McLaughlin to sit behind the rail and observe the meeting.

Community Participation - Medford High School Headmaster Paul D'Alleva - I would like to acknowledge some events of the past weekend regarding the boys soccer team. I received two

letters from the Greater Boston League and I wanted to read them. The first from the Greater Boston League President and the second from the Malden Superintendent. Mr. D'Alleva read the letters of support. Ms. Van der Kloot - Please send thank you letters to the people who wrote in support for our boys soccer team. Mayor Burke - Cambridge supported us, Somerville supported us. There is a time and place for rules. The conversation with the MIAA was appalling. They were unable to look past black and white on a piece of paper. The team deserved their time to win or lose on the field. We pushed ahead and went forward. Since the MIAA could not make the right decision, we went to the court. Thank you to the clerk of courts, thank you to the judge, for staying late on Friday to make the decision. Mr. D'Alleva - It was a team effort. Thank you to everyone who did their best. It was always about the students. I thank the Mayor. And thank you to the Superintendent.

Superintendent's Updates and Comments - I would like to spend my time as well reviewing the situation with the boys soccer team. We talk a lot about the importance of the Mustang Way. We felt the MIAA and the MIAC made an unfair decision and we took it to the courts. When I attended the game I felt I was at a World Cup event, though I was in Lynn. The MIAA stated that they felt badly that a clerical error brought them to the decision that the team should forfeit the whole season, but that rules were meant to be followed. Sometimes the answer to every question may not be a yes or a no. Instead it might be maybe, or let's look more completely into the issue. We are so appreciative of the support Medford received from neighboring cities. The entire community was Medford Strong and rallied around our students. We are proud of the boys soccer team.

This coming Thursday, an important traffic notice: Eversource is closing South Street. This impacts our school buses. Bus routes 12 and 13, Maple Street and South Street, people will have to walk down to Goldilox Bagels to Winthrop Street at South Street. There will be a lot of extra congestion, so please be prepared.

At the High School, we have been experiencing technology issues. We are working on fixing that. We are aware and we are working and meeting collaboratively to find solutions.

Middle School winter sports are starting: boys and girls basketball try-outs were last week and they begin their season December 9th.

Last week Medford SEPAC and Medford Family Network held an informational meeting about supporting students with allergies and the need for supportive classroom environments. Those who are interested but may have missed the presentation, it is available on the blog.

Jumpstart Read for the Record read Thank You Omu. Thank you to all our readers.

A student who just graduated in June 2019, Connor McFarlane won First Place in UMass Amherst's Innovation Challenge. He developed an improved insulin delivery system called IID. He won first place and the Audience Choice Award for his development. Congratulations to Connor.

We celebrated a groundbreaking for the new Cosmetology space thanks to a generous donation from the Hoff Family. There will be a formal ribbon cutting in May of 2020.

The Medford Public Schools partnered with Sandy Hook Promise to provide mental health training program called Start with Hello at the Andrews and McGlynn Middle Schools as well as Medford High School, to train educators and students to know the signs to identify, assess, and intervene before a young person hurts themselves or others. Special thanks to Stacey Schulman for applying for this important grant.

Special thanks to the Fine Arts department, there are many upcoming concerts this winter holiday season, please refer to the website for all upcoming concerts. We will continue to give reminders, but the Fine Arts department has the schedule available. The High School Band will sell Christmas trees starting the weekend after Thanksgiving to support their trip to Pearl Harbor in 2020.

Mr. Ruseau - Do you know how long the South Street closing will last? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - We do not know, but we will be in close communication with Eversource. Mayor Burke - We can get an estimate of the timeline. Mr. Ruseau - When you said technology at the High School, you meant the internet? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes, the internet. We will be able to present out on that some time next month. Ms. DiBenedetto - Can we make sure that an auto call is sent out about South Street to everyone? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes. Ms. DiBenedetto - There have been some emails and concerns about bus crowding. Can you look into that? Dr. Edouard-Vincent - Yes.

Report on CCSR - Mr. Richard Trotta - We found out today that we passed the first step to get a sustaining grant for 10 years and \$250,000. This program is after school so it does not interfere with the school day. The drawback is that we do not get to every student. We started with 18 students at the high school and now we have 150. District wide we now have 500 students involved. The students do a lot of work to help other people, but the students gain the most because they become leaders. CCSR is project-based learning, and it is a powerful tool for learning. The positive experiences of completing a project can counteract some of the negative impacts of negative childhood experiences. Mr. Michael Skorker - CCSR stays with students even after they graduate. Students have a drive to help others. They are benefitting by helping

other people but also by developing life skills. Thank you to all of you who were here to support us from the beginning. Maria Rocha - Founder and Coordinator of CCSR Tufts mentoring chapter for first generation students. Leticia Rocha - We work to foster community among low income first generation students and to provide resources to high school students to get them into college. Marc Alenn Jean-Mary and Keyshana Paul - Haitian Flag Day celebration: last year we took the passion many students feel for Haiti and we channeled it into a celebration. We brought it into the middle schools and elementary schools. We had a celebration after school, we brought in food and a DJ, and we plan to bring in more students next year and make it even more inclusive so that it is more diverse. Jackie Madigan - We create project portfolios and the annual report which we send to the Cummings Foundation. I get the opportunity to work with other students who long to change the world. CCSR has allowed me to build a strong foundation for college, to continue my level of community service in college and for that I am grateful. Emily McDaid - This year I am also working with Jackie on Common Ground, a reverse inclusion classroom which incorporates students in the Access program with the Medford community. Some activities include recognizing uniquenesses available, so students in Access are more involved in the community. Mr. Skorker - Last year at the High School we had 58 projects and this year we are already up to 80 projects at the High School alone. These projects have a real impact on our community and our world. Mr. Trotta - We are incorporating with the Key Club this year. Mayor Burke - Another shout out to the Cummings Foundation, the Krystle Campbell Betterment Project (Boston Foundation), and the Bloomberg Foundation.

Ms. Van der Kloot - Thank you for developing continuity of ideals from elementary to middle to high school, that is very powerful.

Ms. Kreatz - Thank you for your presentation. Ms. DiBenedetto - If this is not grant funded, is there a plan B? Mr. Trotta - I do outreach all the time; there are other grants, if something does not come through there is some time before budget time, but I am confident because the program is getting to be more well-known. The largest cost is stipends for advisors and speakers. Then it is for supplies.

Ms. McLaughlin - Thank you for the presentation. I appreciate how inclusive the group is of students who are often marginalized, especially students with special needs.

Mayor Burke - Thank you again, keep it up, carry it outside of Medford, carry it home. Motion to accept the report and place on file offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Student Representatives to School Committee - Paul D'Alleva - Marc Alenn Jean-Mary and Isabella DeSouza are excellent representatives of the senior class

Mayor Burke - Feel free to jump in and speak up when you have thoughts at the meetings. Ms. Van der Kloot - Please ask us any questions you want, if you have questions before the meetings, reach out to us, your voices are important and we are glad to have your voices here. Mr. Ruseau - I echo what Mayor Burke says, we often thought that the commentary from students is some of the most important. Motion to approve offered by Ms. DiBenedetto seconded by Ms. Kreatz motion passes.

Recognition of Dr. Jan Hollenbeck: AOTA Roster of Fellows - Diane Caldwell - We love to recognize our students but I also enjoy when we can recognize our administrators and Jan Hollenbeck has been honored by the American Occupational Therapy Association. Congratulations to you.

Recommendation to Approve Donation for Library Makerspace - Molly Laden - We received a \$10,000 donation to put a makerspace in the Medford High School library as part of a STEM initiative of Verizon. It is specifically for CTE and academics. It will include high tech and low tech. Ms. Kreatz - Can you tell me more about the student stipend? Ms. Laden - They can be leading activities, student to teacher, student to student. Ms. DiBenedetto - Did you apply for this grant? Ms. Laden - Yes. Ms. DiBenedetto - Thank you for doing that. Ms. Van der Kloot - Thank you, Molly. Motion to approve offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Mr. Ruseau. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Donation from Hoff Family for Cosmetology Department - Chad Fallon - Motion to approve offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Ms. DiBenedetto - The current cosmetology space will be open while you are building the other space, correct? Mr. Fallon - Yes. Ms. DiBenedetto - Community members can still visit the space and have treatments done in the spa, it is a great option to visit the Vocational school. Ms. Van der Kloot - Please ensure that we send a thank you letter. Roll call vote

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Recommendation to Approve Safer Schools and Communities Local Equipment and Technology Grant Award - Dr. Peter Cushing - This was a competitive grant that Assistant Superintendent Kirsteen Patterson applied for and was awarded. Mr. Ruggiero - Will this improve the intercom system? Dr. Cushing - No. Mr. Ruggiero - Will the rooms that lack intercoms be given radios? Dr. Cushing - No, but Mr. D'Alleva is working on a system remedy for that. Mr. Ruseau - I

wanted to let people know that if anyone is looking at the Safer Schools website, one of the things you can use the grant funds for is active shooter training, but that is not what we are using it for. Dr. Cushing - That is correct. Ms. Van der Kloot - My thanks to Assistant Superintendent Patterson. Dr. Cushing - Thanks to Mr. McLaughlin as well. Motion to approve offered by Mr. Ruseau, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Report on After School Program - Megan Fidler-Carey - In the After School program we have been talking a lot this month about what we are grateful for, and I wanted to say now that I am grateful for my staff and the Director of Special Education Joan Bowen, Associate Superintendent Diane Caldwell, and Rachel Perry. You can see in my report that things continue to be challenging. We still have wait lists. We have challenges with recruiting and retaining staff. Mayor Burke - Do families notify you if they find an alternative plan? Ms. Fidler-Carey - No, but I reach out to them and get confirmation. Often even if they get alternative child care they would prefer to be at the schools. Mr. Ruggiero - How many open staff positions do we have? Ms. Fidler-Carey - We can not actually answer that because of the specific needs of students and the specific schedules of teachers, but things change quickly for these positions. It is always in flux. Mr. Ruggiero - Did you consider the senior center or tax deferment? Ms. Fidler-Carey - Yes, but it did not work. Mr. Ruggiero - Have you had any issues with families on vouchers? Ms. Fidler-Carey - I can look into Childcare Choices, our voucher partner, they can look into families on the voucher wait list. Ms. Mustone - What is the plan for sign ups for next year? Ms. Fidler-Carey - We are going to do sign ups at individual schools on different days so I can be present. We are going to have site coordinators present. I want to develop relationships. Ms. Mustone - Will you do first come first served? Ms. Fidler-Carey - I have heard a lot of negative stories about lotteries but I will look into the possibilities and let you know. Ms. Mustone - Are you able to see what you bring in and what you spend for your budget? Ms. Fidler-Carey - I am keeping track of what we spend. Ms. DiBenedetto - I want to make sure all employees are making minimum wage in this district. I request a report on that for our next meeting. I request a report on budget that is going in and out for the school year including after school. Mayor Burke - She does that every meeting. Ms. Van der Kloot - Make a motion that we receive a financial report on the after school program. What are staff paid? In the past some of the money we took in was used for other areas in the district. Even though we may be competitive with other districts, we may have to be better than other districts.

Motion to see the complete and current before and after school budget offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Mr. Ruseau - A lottery system may not be perfect but the current system is the least equitable solution possible. Can we find a time to see your strategic plan? Ms. Fidler-Carey - I have been thinking about my bench, building leadership from within, and I put out a notice to staff to try to build a committee to develop a strategic plan. Mr. Ruggiero - Motion to study full enrollment, eliminate the waitlist.

Ms. McLaughlin - How are accommodations made for EL students or students with disabilities? Ms. Fidler-Carey - We make accommodations as best we can, we work with school day staff, we work with families, as Medford Public Schools employees we are able to see 504 and IEP plans, but our staff are not certified educators necessarily, so we work closely with school day staff and adjustment counselors to navigate IEPs. We have worked to get trainings and professional development. It is on a case by case basis.

Motion to have a complete financial analysis of the program presented for the next meeting offered by Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. DiBenedetto, motion passes.

Motion to have a study of universal after school care offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. Van der Kloot, motion passes.

Report on Math Learning Walks - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent - A video of the learning walks was shown. Dr. Edouard-Vincent - The intention of the video is to show that we are taking instruction seriously and that the school leaders and administrators are participating in other schools as well. We are paying close attention to mathematics and to subgroups. Motion to accept the report and place on file offered by Ms. Kreatz, seconded by Mr. Ruggiero, motion passes.

Report on Superintendent's Goals - Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent - We have been working on our strategic plan and working on what has been happening academically. We have been keeping a laser-like focus on instruction. The entire district is participating in learning walks, expanding to all schools and all administrators, everyone has skin in the game and everyone is invested. Our student learning goal has math as the content area where we would like to make the greatest improvements. I had hoped to hit a 10% improvement target, which we fell short of in my first year, reaching improvement of 6.7%. I am aiming for another 10% increase for this year. I do feel that we need to have an aspirational goal to push for at the elementary level in mathematics. My professional practice goal is to continue the NSIP training for this year. Mr. Ruseau - The next year's goals may not be these same goals. When I went to the MASC conference we discussed this. We should be going over this in the spring for the following school year. We are in a boss/employee relationship and the employee does not traditionally say "this is my goal as an employee" and the boss says "okay." Next year we, as the School Committee, will work with

you on what the goals will be. I would like you to be able to be evaluated honestly and fairly, based on the goals we set out together. Ms. Van der Kloot - We may need to set out School Committee goals or a School Committee strategic plan.

Motion to accept the Superintendent's Goals offered by Ms. DiBenedetto, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Condolences were read by Mayor Burke.

Motion to enter executive session.

Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Committee entered Executive Session at 9:26pm.

Motion to exit executive session offered by Mr. Ruggiero, seconded by Ms. Kreatz. Roll call vote.

7 - Affirmative

0 - Negative

Motion passes.

Motion to adjourn at 9: 49pm.